G • GTA PORTAL

STUDENT GUIDE · APPLICANT EDITION

# How to Apply for a Graduate Teaching Assistant Position

A step-by-step walkthrough of the GTA Portal — from signing in and building your profile, to submitting an application and tracking its status.

**George Mason University** · GTA Portal
gta-portal.onrender.com
Prepared for applicants · October 2026

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> **Scope of this guide:** This document covers the **Applicant** experience only — browsing courses, building your profile, submitting an application, and tracking its status. Faculty Reviewer and Admin tools are not covered here.

SECTION 1

# Before You Start

The GTA Portal is where you apply for Graduate Teaching Assistant positions, submit one application per term, and track its status in one place — replacing the old paper/PowerApps process. You'll sign in with your GMU email, so there's nothing to install.

## Have these ready

You can start an application with just a few minutes and the basics below — anything you leave blank can be filled in later from your profile.

- ✓ Your GMU G-Number
- ✓ A phone number you can be reached at
- ✓ The course(s) you'd like to be considered for, and the term
- ✓ Your current cumulative GPA (3.0 minimum is required to apply)
- ✓ Your resume/CV as a PDF or DOCX file (optional at submission time, but recommended)
- ✓ Names of one or two professors who could speak to your work, for the Letter of Recommendation field (no file needed — just their names)

> **Tip:** Fill out *My Profile* before you apply. Most of the information the application wizard asks for — your name, G-Number, program, degree, GPA, and more — is pulled from your profile automatically and reused on every future application, so you only type it once. Section 4 of this guide walks through it.

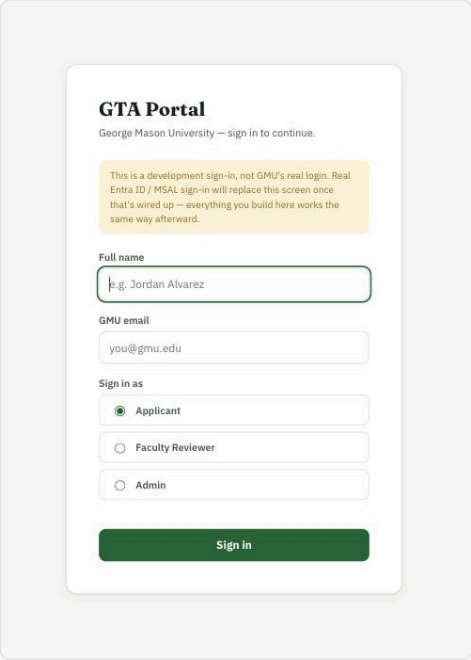
## One application, multiple courses

Each time you apply, you can select up to **10 course sections** you'd be available to support in a single application. A faculty member will assign you to a specific section (and set your hours) if you're hired — you don't need to coordinate that part yourself.

SECTION 2

# Signing In

Go to the GTA Portal at **gta-portal.onrender.com** in any browser. You'll land on the sign-in screen shown below.




*The GTA Portal sign-in screen.*

## 1 Enter your name and GMU email

Type your full name and your `@gmu.edu` email address. These identify your account and are used to pre-fill your application.

## 2 Choose "Applicant"

Under **Sign in as**, make sure **Applicant** is selected (it's selected by default). The other two options, Faculty Reviewer and Admin, are for course faculty and portal administrators and show a different set of screens.

## 3 Click Sign in

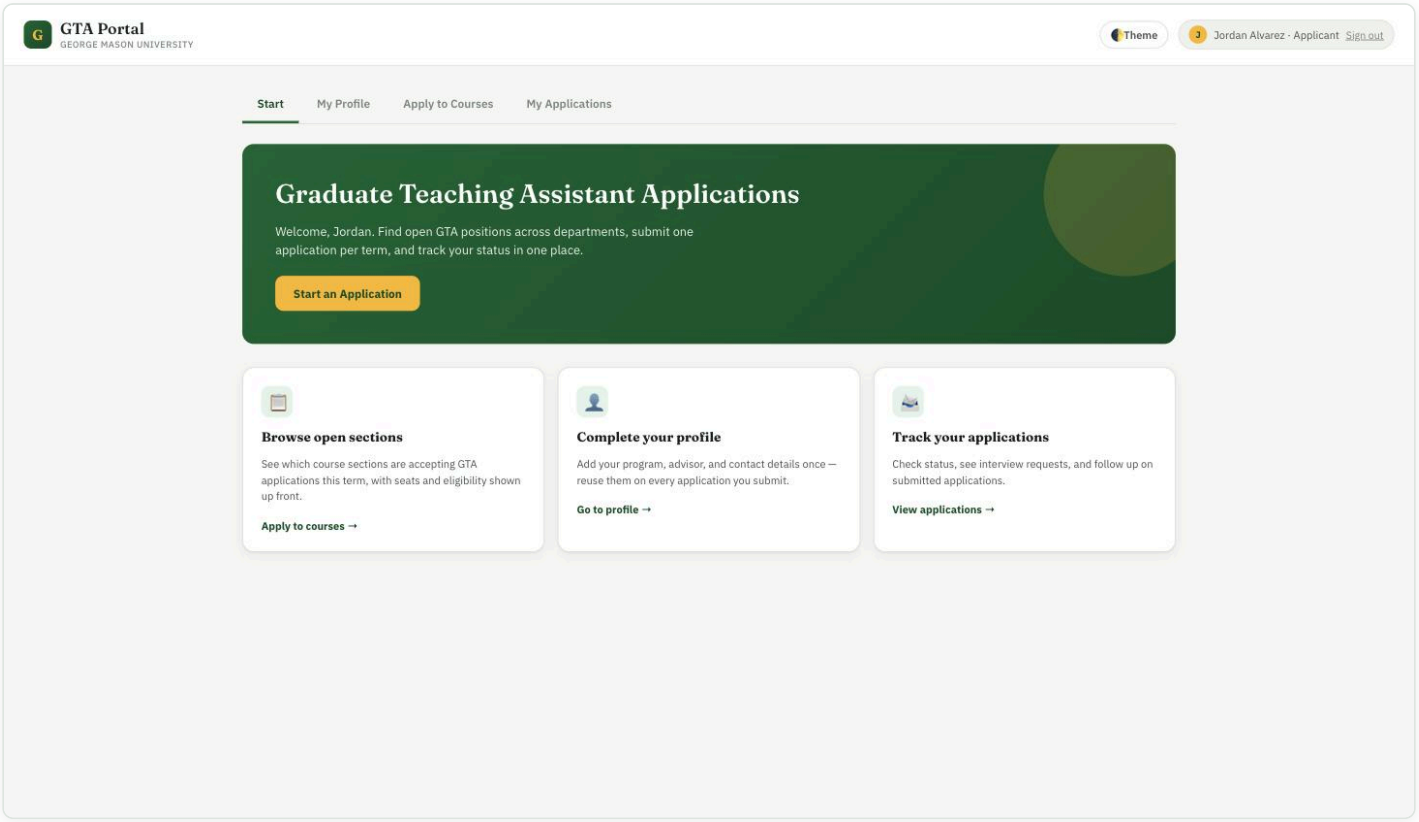
You'll be taken straight to the portal's home screen, signed in under your name.

> **About this sign-in screen:** the portal currently uses a simplified GMU-email sign-in while it's being rolled out. A banner on the page notes that this will be replaced by GMU's real single sign-on (Entra ID/MSAL) later — when that happens, you'll sign in with your usual GMU credentials instead, but everything else in this guide works exactly the same way afterward.

SECTION 3

# The Home Screen

After signing in, you'll land on the **Start** tab. This is your home base — from here you can jump to any of the three things you'll do most often.




*The Start screen, with the three main actions available to applicants.*

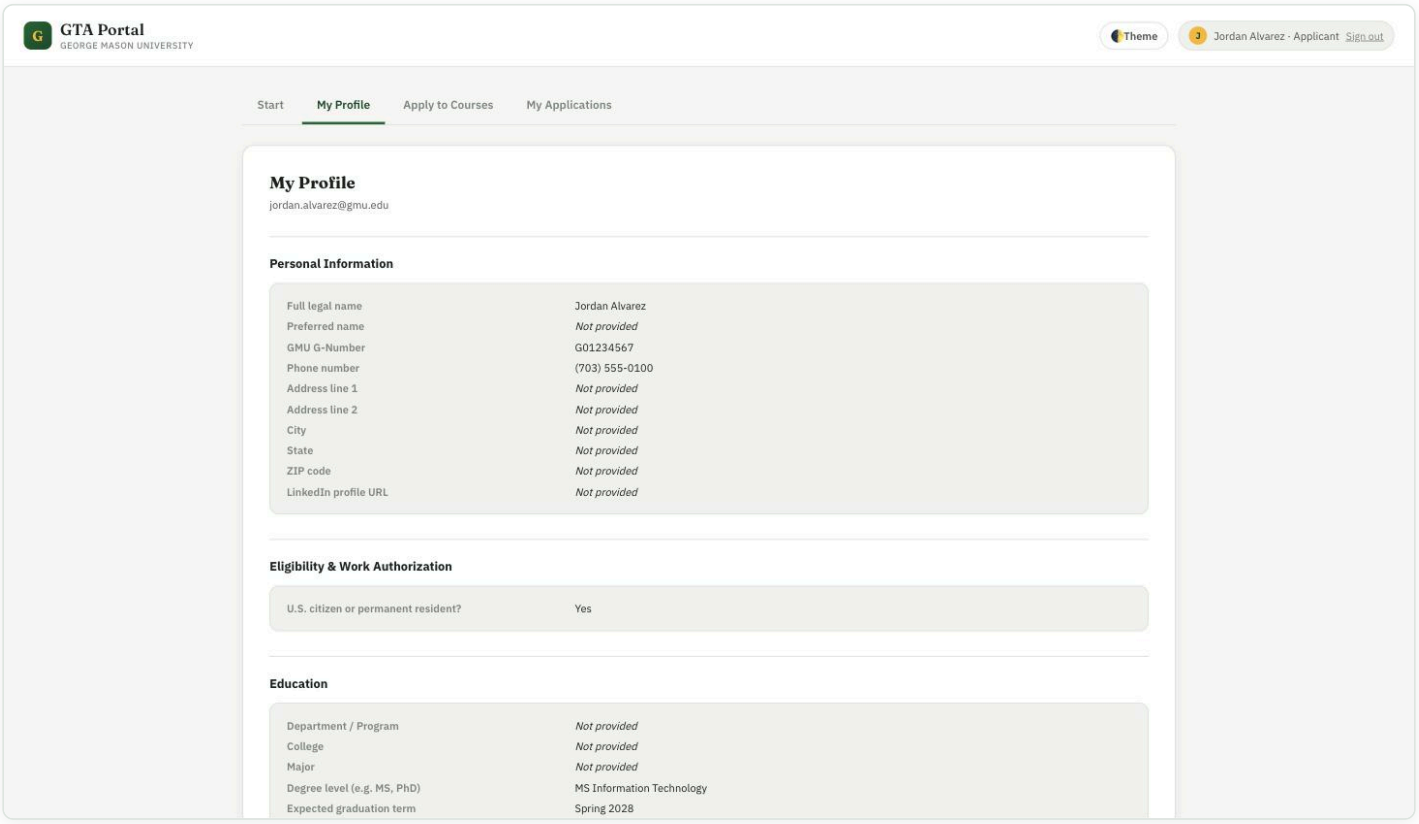
| Card | What it does |
|---|---|
| **Browse open sections** | Takes you into the application wizard, starting with the list of course sections currently accepting GTA applications. |
| **Complete your profile** | Opens *My Profile*, where you enter the information that gets reused automatically across every application you submit. |
| **Track your applications** | Opens *My Applications*, a table of everything you've submitted and its current status. |

The same four tabs — **Start**, **My Profile**, **Apply to Courses**, and **My Applications** — stay available across the top of the screen wherever you go in the portal, so you can jump between them at any time without losing your place.

SECTION 4 · RECOMMENDED FIRST STEP

# Completing Your Profile

Open **My Profile** from the top tab bar (or the "Complete your profile" card on Start). The first time, you'll see a *Create your profile* prompt — click it to open the profile form, organized into five sections.




*Your profile, once filled in — shown here in read-only view. Click "Edit profile" at the bottom to make changes.*

| Section | What's in it |
|---|---|
| **Personal Information** | Legal name, preferred name, G-Number, phone, mailing address, LinkedIn URL. |
| **Eligibility & Work Authorization** | Whether you're a U.S. citizen or permanent resident. If not, you'll also be asked about your Social Security Number and whether you're a new GTA — which in turn determines whether you need to complete CELTD (new GTAs) or upload a CELTD certificate (returning GTAs). |
| **Education** | Department/program, college, major, degree level, expected graduation term. If you've earned a degree before, you'll also enter that degree's details. |
| **Experience** | Prior TA/grading experience, recommenders, and yes/no questions about prior GTA experience, prior IT industry experience, and whether you've worked at GMU before — each opens a couple of follow-up fields when answered "Yes." |
| **Documents** | Resume and unofficial transcript uploads. |

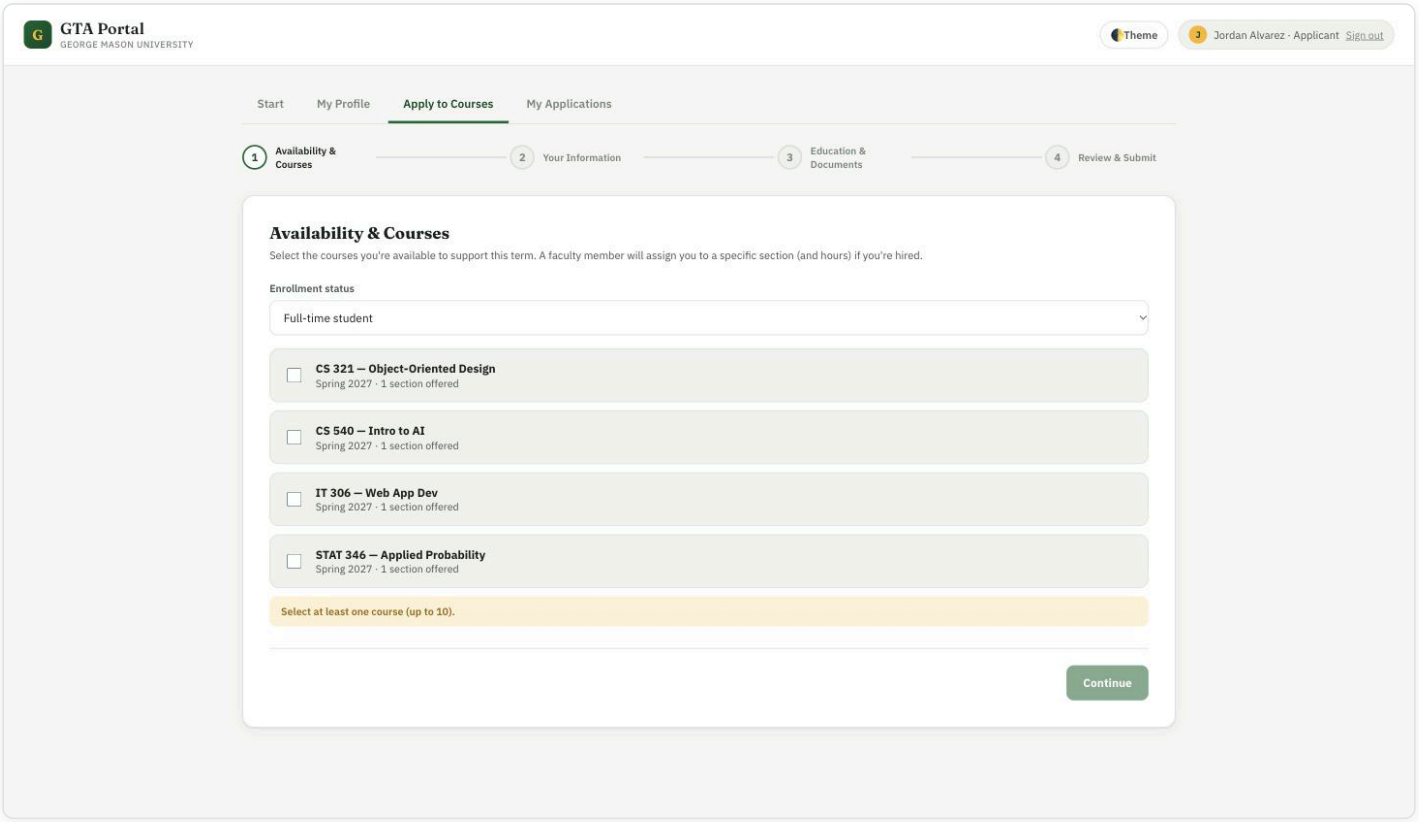
> **Why this matters:** everything you enter here — your name, G-Number, phone, program, degree, expected graduation, prior experience, recommenders, and resume — is pulled in automatically the next time you fill out an application, so you don't retype it. Questions like your GPA, final-semester status, and tuition status are also only asked **once**, the first time you apply, and reused after that (more on this in Section 7).

When you're done, click **Save profile**. You can come back and click **Edit profile** at any time to update your information.

SECTION 5 · APPLICATION WIZARD — STEP 1 OF 4

# Availability & Courses

Click **Apply to Courses** in the top tab bar (or "Browse open sections" / "Start an Application" on the Start screen) to begin a new application.




*Step 1 — choosing enrollment status and course sections.*

## 1 Set your enrollment status

Choose **Full-time student** or **Part-time student** from the dropdown. This affects how many courses you're required to have registered for the upcoming semester (see Section 7).

## 2 Select your course(s)

Check the box next to every course section you'd be available to support this term. You can select up to **10 courses** in one application — the page keeps a running count ("x of 10 courses selected") and won't let you continue until you've picked at least one.

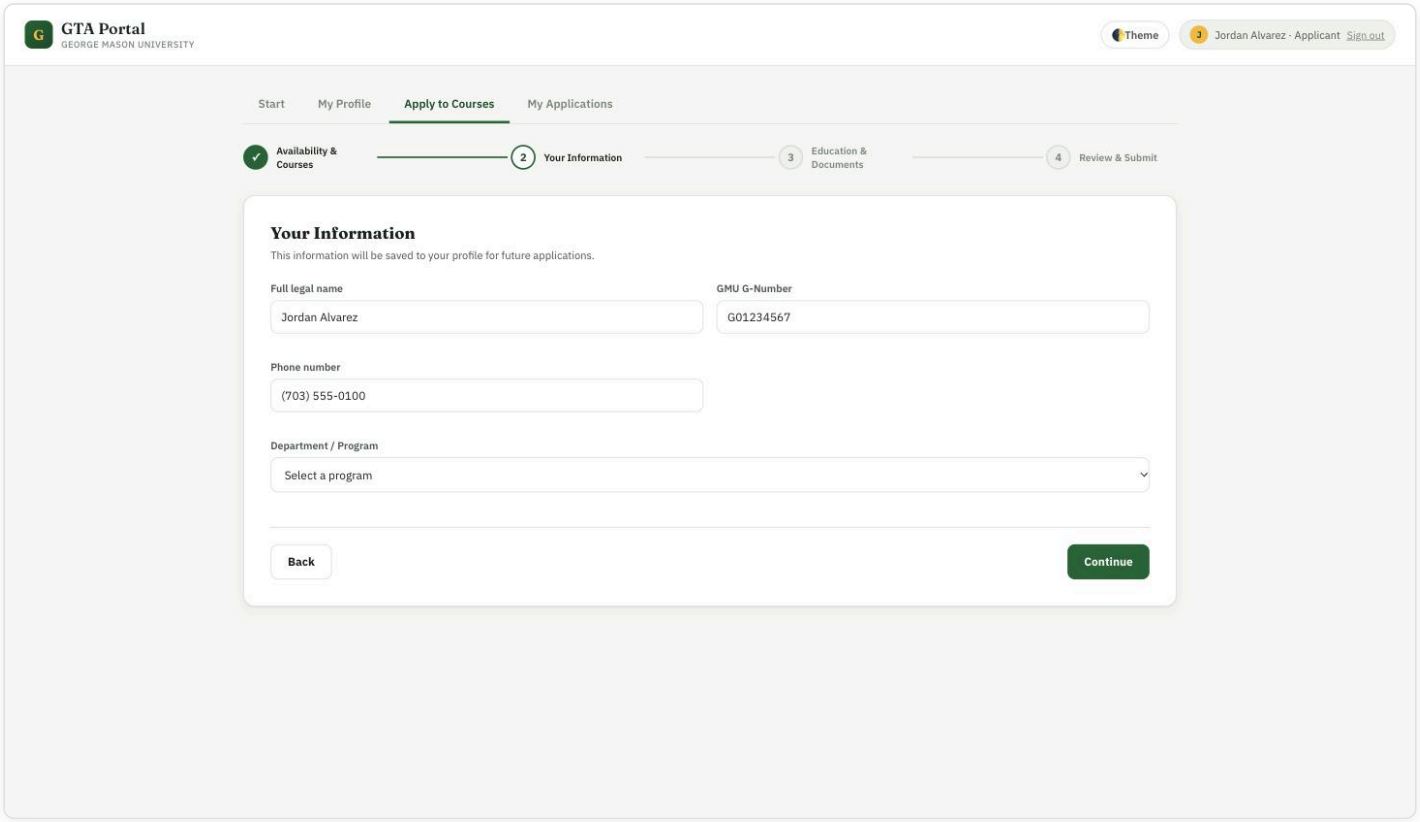
> Being hired isn't automatic for every course you select — selecting a course means you're available and interested. A faculty member reviews applications and assigns a specific section and hours if you're chosen.

Click **Continue** once you've made your selections.

SECTION 6 · APPLICATION WIZARD — STEP 2 OF 4

# Your Information

This step confirms the contact details that will travel with your application. If you've already completed your profile, every field here arrives pre-filled.




*Step 2 — pre-filled from your profile when available.*

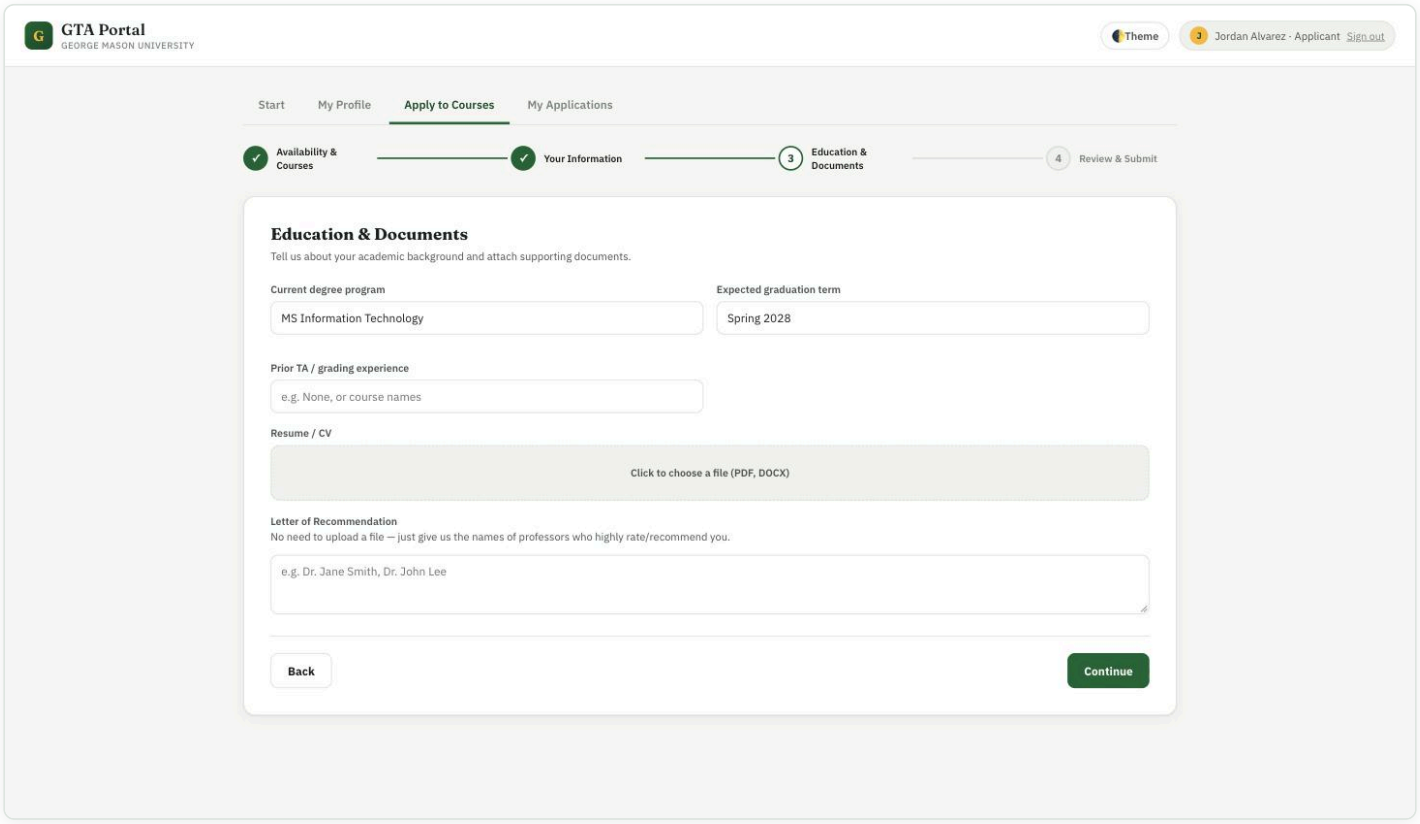
| Field | Notes |
|---|---|
| Full legal name | Pre-filled from your profile. |
| GMU G-Number | Format: G01234567. |
| Phone number | A number you can be reached at. |
| Department / Program | Choose from the dropdown list of GMU departments/programs. |

Double-check these fields even if they're pre-filled — this is what gets saved back to your profile when you submit, so any correction you make here updates your profile for next time too. Click **Continue** when you're ready, or **Back** to revisit your course selections.

SECTION 7 · APPLICATION WIZARD — STEP 3 OF 4

# Education & Documents

This step covers your academic background and supporting documents. Its length varies from one applicant to the next — some questions are only asked the **first time** you ever apply, then reused automatically after that.




*Step 3 — education details and document uploads. The fields below appear underneath this on your first-ever application.*

## Always shown

| Field | Notes |
|---|---|
| Current degree program | e.g. "MS Information Technology." |
| Expected graduation term | e.g. "Spring 2028." |
| Prior TA / grading experience | Free text — enter "None" if you have none. |
| Resume / CV | Click the upload box to attach a PDF or DOCX. |
| Letter of Recommendation | No file needed — just list the names of professors who'd highly recommend you. |

## Asked once, then reused automatically

The first time you ever start an application, you'll also see these questions. Once answered, they won't be shown again on future applications — your earlier answer is reused.

| Question | Notes |
|---|---|
| Cumulative GPA | **A 3.0 minimum is required to apply.** |
| Is this your final semester? | Yes/No. |
| Courses registered for the upcoming semester | Minimum is **2 courses** — except full-time students in their final semester, who only need **1**. |
| Tuition status | In-state or out-of-state. |

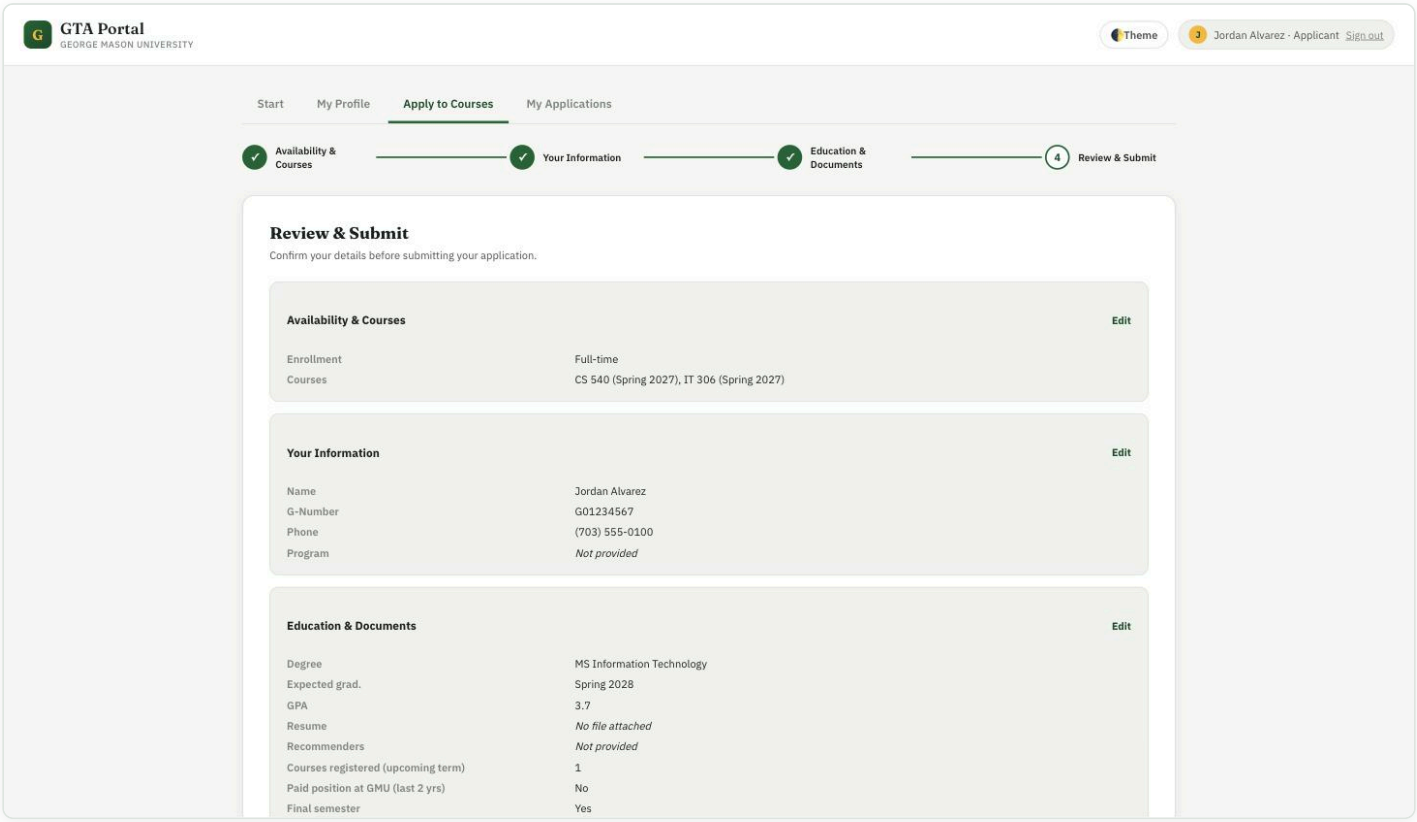
| | |
|---|---|
| Held a paid position at GMU in the last 2 years? | If you answer **No**, you'll also confirm whether you've completed the Employee Onboarding Packet and the I-9 Form. |

> **Hours worked outside GMU** works a little differently — it's asked **once per semester** rather than once ever. You'll see it again the first time you apply to a term you haven't answered it for yet, even if you answered it for an earlier term. Enter **0** if you don't work outside GMU.

SECTION 8 · APPLICATION WIZARD — STEP 4 OF 4

# Review & Submit

The final step lays out everything you've entered, grouped by section, so you can check it over before it goes to faculty reviewers.



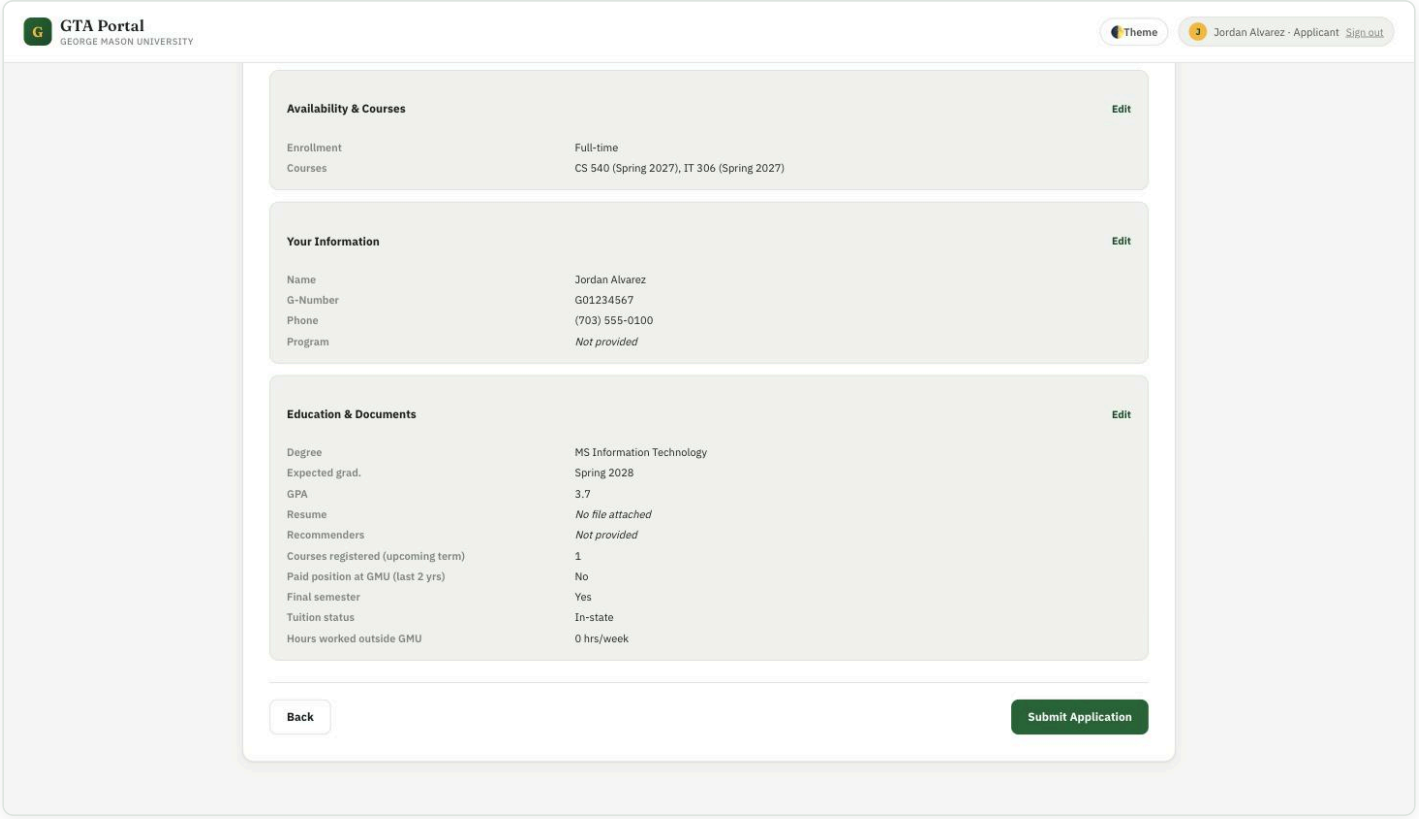

*The top of the Review & Submit screen — Availability & Courses and Your Information.*

## 1 Check each section

Availability & Courses, Your Information, and Education & Documents each appear as their own card. Anything left blank shows as *Not provided* in italics — worth a second look before you submit.

## 2 Fix anything that's off

Click **Edit** on any card to jump straight back to that step of the wizard. Your other answers are kept, so you won't need to start over.




*The bottom of the Review & Submit screen — Education & Documents, and the Submit Application button.*

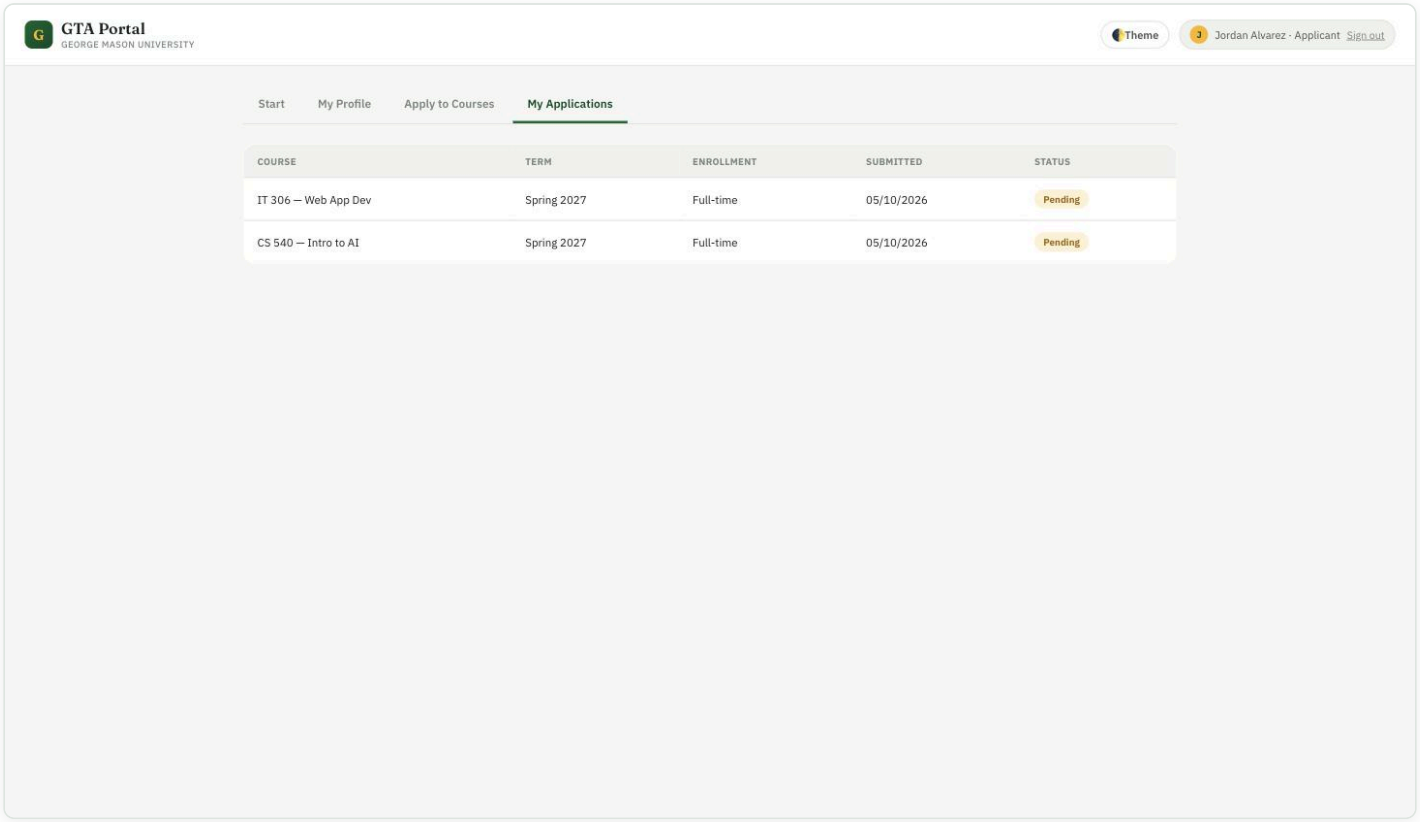
## 3 Submit

Once everything looks right, click **Submit Application**. You'll be taken directly to **My Applications**, where your new submission appears right away.

SECTION 9

# Tracking Your Application

Open the **My Applications** tab at any time to see everything you've submitted.




*My Applications, showing two courses from a single submission — each tracked separately.*

If you selected more than one course in a single application, each course gets its own row here, so you can follow its status independently.

| Column | What it shows |
|---|---|
| Course | The course code and title. |
| Term | The semester the course is offered. |
| Enrollment | Full-time or part-time, as you set it in Step 1. |
| Submitted | The date you submitted the application. |
| Status | Where it stands — see below. |

## Status meanings

**Pending** Your application has been received and is awaiting review by a faculty member.

**Interview** A faculty member would like to speak with you about the position before deciding.

**Hired** You've been selected. A faculty member will follow up with your section assignment and hours.

If you haven't submitted anything yet, this page shows a prompt to start your first application instead of the table above.